

Switching between an active mask and an active layer

As soon as you create your mask, it is made *active*—you can now paint on it and apply filters to it. You will notice that the colours in the toolbox have changed to black and white, and the thumbnail for the default colours now show white as the foreground with black as the background. In the Layers palette, the thumbnail for the mask has a thicker border than the main layer.

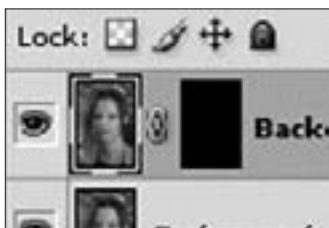


Signs that the Mask is active



Signs that the Layer is active

If you'd like to edit the layer and not its mask, click on its thumbnail. Now, the layer's thumbnail will have the thicker border, the colours in the toolbox will revert to whatever they were before you started with the mask, and the default colours will once again be black foreground and white background.



The chain-link icon in the middle tells us that the Layer and Mask are linked

Linking and unlinking masks

By default, layers and their masks are linked to each other—if you use the move tool to move a mask, the layer moves with it and vice-versa. The chain-link icon between the two thumbnails indicates this linkage.

If you'd like to move or transform the layer and mask independently of each other, you can unlink them by clicking on the chain-link icon.

Temporarily disabling the mask

If you want to see what an image looks like without the mask, hold down [Shift] and click on the mask's thumbnail. A red "X"